

Governance

1. Meaning of Governance and Government

- Governance is the process of making decisions, creating rules (laws), organising society, and ensuring that rules are followed.
 - A government is the group or system that makes laws and implements them.
 - Some important rules are called laws.
 - Rules are necessary to maintain order, harmony, and proper functioning of society.
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2. Why Do We Need a Government?

- When people live together, disagreements and conflicts can arise.
 - Without rules and authority, society cannot function properly.
 - The government:
 - Maintains law and order
 - Provides public services
 - Ensures justice and safety
 - Makes policies for development
 - Government works for the welfare of the people.
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3. Three Organs of Government

A modern government has three branches:

(a) Legislature

- Makes laws.
- In India:
 - At national level: Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha
 - At state level: Vidhan Sabha (State Assembly)

(b) Executive

- **Implements (executes) laws.**
- **Includes:**
 - **President (nominal head)**
 - **Prime Minister (real executive head)**
 - **Governor (nominal head in state)**
 - **Chief Minister (state executive head)**
 - **Police and administrative officers**

(c) Judiciary

- **Interprets laws.**
- **Decides if laws are broken.**
- **Punishes lawbreakers.**
- **Includes:**
 - **Supreme Court (national level)**
 - **High Courts (state level)**

4. Separation of Powers

- **The three organs should remain separate but work together.**
- **This system is called separation of powers.**
- **It creates checks and balances so no organ becomes too powerful.**

5. Three Tiers (Levels) of Government in India

India has a three-level system:

- 1. Local Government (village/town level)**
- 2. State Government**
- 3. Central (Union) Government**

Each level handles different responsibilities.

Example:

- **Local issues → Local government**

- State matters → State government
 - National matters (defence, currency, foreign affairs) → Central government
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6. Democracy

- Democracy means rule of the people.
- The word comes from:
 - *Demos* = People
 - *Kratos* = Rule

Types of Democracy

(a) Direct Democracy

- People themselves vote on decisions.
- Example: Class voting for a picnic place.

(b) Representative Democracy

- People elect representatives to make decisions.
 - India is a representative democracy.
 - Representatives:
 - MLAs (State level)
 - MPs (National level)
 - All citizens above 18 years can vote.
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7. Grassroots Democracy

- Focuses on participation of ordinary citizens.
 - Encourages involvement from the base level (local level).
 - Ensures people have a voice in decisions affecting them.
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8. Importance of Democracy

- Ensures equality and justice.
- Promotes development.

- **Respects dignity and identity of people and cultures.**
- **Works through elections and public participation.**